



Remember to use a camera first to see if you like the controls, how it sits in your hands, and also see if you're comfortable with the weight

GPS

Speaking of things of no importance, cameras nowadays are coming with built-in GPS capabilities. To clarify, no, these will not get you from point A to point B. There are not navigation capable in any way.

What these built-in GPS chips do is tag the photo you've just shot with the location information. Sounds great but we see two problems with that; 1) *You* are *at* the location, right? do you really need a camera to tell you where you are?, and 2) Privacy concerns.

A photo taken inside your home will also get tagged with the location information, and if you post it online without removing these, people now know exactly where you live.

We say save the money and get the non-GPS version of the camera you might be eyeing.

Smile detection

We're also wary of those "smile-and-face-detect" focusing systems as we've seen that they tend to grab the wrong subject almost as often as they lock focus on the right one. The focusing on cameras nowadays is good enough to be able to lock onto the subject quite intelligently so anything more than that is just unnecessary fluff.

Scene modes

Last but not least, cameras with a million and a half scene modes add nothing really essential to the image. Earlier, cameras shipped with just a handful of these scene modes, which were quite useful such as low light, portrait and landscape scenes. However, now we have so many modes which are just a spinoff on the original few. Instead of going for so many scene modes, we say the smart thing to do would be to pick up a camera that allows shooting in manual mode.

Recommendations

There's so many cameras out there (and so many more to come) that we find it a little difficult to make recommendations. Regardless, here are the three cameras we think are most bang for your buck.

Canon SX240 HS (₹17,995)

The winner of our travel zoom shootout, the SX240 HS is an excellent performer with a modest focal length. The battery on it lasts quite a while too.

Sony HX20V (₹19,500)

This camera has given solid competition to the Canon SX240 HS and is about the same price and delivers the same performance. The camera is also built quite well, so there won't be any need to handle the camera like a delicate doll.

Sony RX100 (₹34,990)

The big game changer from Sony, the RX100 features not only a bigger sensor (a 1-inch sensor), but also bigger individual pixels on the sensor itself. All that spells out is better image quality and much better low light performance. Then there is also the fast aperture f/1.8 lens. Definitely more expensive than the rest, but the features on this little camera justify it completely.

Do not think we've forgotten about the enthusiasts looking to go pro. We also have some DSLR recommendations from our extensive testing.

Entry Level: Nikon 3200 (₹48,950)

Nikon's entry-level contender, the D3200 has a 12 megapixel sensor that is very capable when it comes to capturing dynamic range and contrast. It's compact, lightweight and doesn't compromise on features or quality.

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